

Problem 20

Among students attending a probability theory class, we randomly select one. Let event A mean that the selected student is male. Further, let event B mean that he does not smoke, and event C that he lives in a student dormitory.

- 1° Describe event $AB\bar{C}$.
- 2° Under what conditions does the identity $ABC = A$ hold?
- 3° When will the relation $\bar{C} \subseteq B$ be correct?
- 4° Explain when the equality $\bar{A} = B$ occurs, and does it occur when all present males do not smoke?

Solution

Given Events

- A = selected student is male
- B = selected student does not smoke
- C = selected student lives in a student dormitory

Therefore:

- $\bar{A}$ = selected student is female
- $\bar{B}$ = selected student smokes
- $\bar{C}$ = selected student does not live in a dormitory

Part 1°: Describe $AB\bar{C}$

Analysis

The event $AB\bar{C}$ is the intersection of three events:

$$AB\bar{C} = A \cap B \cap \bar{C}$$

Description

$AB\bar{C}$ = The selected student is a male who does not smoke and does not live in a dormitory

This event occurs when all three conditions are satisfied simultaneously:

- The student is male (event A)
- The student does not smoke (event B)
- The student does NOT live in a dormitory (event $\bar{C}$)

Part 2°: Under what conditions does $ABC = A$ hold?

Analysis

The equation $ABC = A$ means:

$$A \cap B \cap C = A$$

This holds if and only if $A \subseteq B \cap C$, i.e., $A \subseteq B$ and $A \subseteq C$.

Interpretation

$A \subseteq B$ means: Every male student does not smoke (all males are non-smokers)

$A \subseteq C$ means: Every male student lives in a dormitory (all males live in dorms)

Answer

$$ABC = A \iff \text{All male students are non-smokers AND all male students live in dormitories}$$

Equivalently:

$$ABC = A \iff A \subseteq B \text{ and } A \subseteq C$$

Condition: Every male student must satisfy both conditions: not smoking and living in a dormitory.

Verification

If all males are non-smokers and live in dorms, then: - Selecting a male (A) automatically means selecting a non-smoker (B) and dormitory resident (C) - Therefore $ABC = A$

Conversely, if $ABC = A$, then every element of A must also be in B and C , so $A \subseteq B \cap C$.

Part 3°: When is $\bar{C} \subseteq B$ correct?

Analysis

The relation $\bar{C} \subseteq B$ means:

Every student who doesn't live in a dormitory is a non-smoker

Interpretation

This means: If a student does not live in a dormitory, then that student does not smoke.

Equivalently: All students living outside dormitories are non-smokers.

Or: No student who lives outside a dormitory smokes.

Answer

$$\bar{C} \subseteq B \iff \text{All students not living in dormitories are non-smokers}$$

Condition: There are no smokers among students who live outside dormitories.

Equivalently: $\bar{C}\bar{B} = \emptyset$ (no one both lives outside dorms AND smokes)

Or using the contrapositive: $\bar{B} \subseteq C$ (all smokers live in dormitories)

Part 4°: When does $\bar{A} = B$ occur? Does it occur when all males don't smoke?

Part (a): When does $\bar{A} = B$ hold?

The equality $\bar{A} = B$ means:

The set of female students equals the set of non-smoking students

This requires two conditions:

1. $\bar{A} \subseteq B$: All females are non-smokers
2. $B \subseteq \bar{A}$: All non-smokers are female

Combined meaning:

$$\bar{A} = B \iff \text{A student is female if and only if they don't smoke}$$

Equivalently:

- All females are non-smokers
- All males are smokers
- All non-smokers are female
- All smokers are male

Part (b): Does $\bar{A} = B$ occur when all males don't smoke?

Given condition: All present males do not smoke, i.e., $A \subseteq B$.

Question: Does this imply $\bar{A} = B$?

Analysis:

If all males don't smoke ($A \subseteq B$), this means:

$$A \cap \bar{B} = \emptyset \quad (\text{no male smokers})$$

For $\bar{A} = B$ to hold, we need:

- All females don't smoke: $\bar{A} \subseteq B$
- All non-smokers are female: $B \subseteq \bar{A}$

But if all males don't smoke ($A \subseteq B$), then males are among the non-smokers, so $B \not\subseteq \bar{A}$.
Therefore:

NO, $\bar{A} = B$ does NOT occur when all males don't smoke

Reason: When all males don't smoke, the non-smoking group (B) includes males, so $B \neq \bar{A}$ (which contains only females).

For $\bar{A} = B$ to hold, we would need:

- All males smoke (so no males in B)
- All females don't smoke (so all of $\bar{A}$ is in B)

This is the **opposite** of the given condition.

Counterexample

Suppose:

- There are 10 males, all non-smokers
- There are 5 females, all non-smokers

Then:

- $\bar{A} = 5$ females
- $B = 15$ non-smokers (10 males + 5 females)
- $\bar{A} \neq B$ since $|\bar{A}| = 5 \neq 15 = |B|$

Final Answer

- 1° $ABC = \text{Male, non-smoker, not living in dormitory}$
- 2° $ABC = A \iff \text{All males are non-smokers and live in dormitories}$
- 3° $\bar{C} \subseteq B \iff \text{All students not in dorms are non-smokers}$
- 4° $\bar{A} = B \iff \text{Student is female iff non-smoker}$
 NO, this does NOT occur when all males don't smoke

Key insight for 4°: The equality $\bar{A} = B$ requires that females and non-smokers are exactly the same set. This would require all males to smoke (not don't smoke) and all females to not smoke.